* Power Query :- It is a data connection and data transformation tool in Microsoft Excel used to import, clean, transform, combine and prepare data for analysis.

It helps us prepare raw data before using it in Pivot Tables, Charts, dashboards, or other data analysis tasks.

In simple words, Power Query helps us convert raw data into clean, organized, analysis - ready data without manually editing every row.

Append (Stack Vertically) =
Merge (Join Horizontally).

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(*) Why do we use Power Query?

Imagine you receive an Excel file containing 1,000 employee records with duplicate rows, blank values, incorrect data types, & inconsistent spellings.

Cleaning everything manually can take a lot of time. Power Query allows you to perform these cleaning operations systematically & repeat them whenever the source data changes.

(*) Main Uses :-

- Import data from Excel files, CSV files websites, datasets, & other supported sources.
- Remove duplicate records and unnecessary columns.
- Remove blank rows and handle missing values.
- Change column names & datatypes.
- Filter and Sort records.
- Split or combine columns.
- Merge data from different tables.
- Append data from multiple tables.
- Refresh the query when the source data is updated.
- Keep a record of the transformation steps performed.

(*) Power Query Editor :- It is the workspace where we clean, modify and transform data before loading it into Excel.

(*) Steps to use Power Query in Excel :-

There are different ways to import data into Power Query. These are the most common methods.

> Method 1 : Import data from a website

Step 1 : Open the "Data" tab, Select "get data" and choose "from other Sources" → "From web".

Step 2 : Enter the website URL.

Copy the URL of the webpage containing the table you want to analyze & paste it into URL field. Click OK.

Step 3 : Select the required table.

Excel displays the tables it can identify on the webpage. Select the appropriate table & choose "Transform Data" to open Power Query Editor.

Step 4 : Clean and transform the data.

Rename columns, remove unnecessary rows, filter data, check for errors, & set the correct datatypes.

Step 5 : Load the data into Excel.

After completing the transformations, click Home → Close & Load.

> Method 2 : Import an Existing Excel table.

1. Select your dataset in Excel.
2. Convert it into a table using Ctrl + T, if it is not already in a table.
3. Go to Data → From Table / Range.
4. Power Query Editor opens.
5. Perform the required transformation.
6. Select Close & Load to return the result to Excel.

(*) Merge → Match tables & Add Columns.
(*) Append → Stack tables & Add Rows.

(*) Difference between Power Query & Normal Excel data cleaning :-

Feature	Manual Excel Cleaning	Power Query.
Cleaning data	Often requires repeated manual work.	Records repeatable steps.
Duplicate Removal	Available.	Available.
Data type changes	Available	Available.
Combining datasets	Formulas, Lookups or manual work.	Merge And Append
Updating data	May require repeating operations.	Refreshes Saved transformations.

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Best use	Quick edits and simple tasks.	Repeatable data import and preparation

- Power Query doesn't replace Excel formulas or charts. Instead, it complements them by preparing the data before Analysis.

- Power Query is an important tool for a Data analyst because it helps automate repetitive data-cleaning tasks, combine datasets, & prepare reliable data for reporting & visualization.